SCHEME OF WORK

Week	Topic
1	Comprehension: Reading for Main Points; Structure: Revision on Nominalization of Adjectives and Verbs; Speech Work: Review of Consonants Followed by /j/ and /u/ Sounds; Summary: Revision of the Features of Summary.
2	Comprehension: Learning about Main Ideas and Supporting Details; Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with the Human Body System and Functions; Speech Work: Cluster of Two, Three and Four Consonants; Writing (Expository): Meaning, Features and Examples.
3	Comprehension: Reading to Follow Writer's Ideas; Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Health; Structure: Noun Phrases: Meaning, Identification and Functions.
4	Summary: Reading to Summarise; Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Building and Building Construction; Writing (Narrative): Meaning, Features and Examples; Structure: Relative Pronouns.
5	Comprehension: Reading For Main Points; Speech Work: Unstressed Vowel Sound /ə/; Writing (Argumentative).
6	Comprehension: Reading to Extract the Main Points from a Passage; Structure: Sentence Types; Speech Work: Stress Of Four Syllable Words; Writing (Descriptive).
7	Comprehension: Reading to Take Notes; Structure: Adverb Types; Summary: Reading to Summarise an Argument.
8	Structure: Word Modifiers (Adjectives and Adverbs); Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Colours, Smell and Taste; Comprehension (Listening); Writing: A Report.

Week	Topic
9	Structure: Plural Forms of Nouns; Speech Work: Stress of Five Syllable Words; Writing (Creative Writing): Features of a Short Story; Summary Writing: Identifying Topic Sentences.
10	Comprehension: Reading to Paraphrase a Prose Passage; Structure: Phrasal Verbs; Writing: Features and Format of an Informal Letter.
11	Revision
12	Examination

COURSE CONTENT

WEEK 1

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: NOMINALIZATION OF ADJECTIVES AND VERBS; SUMMARY WRITING: FEATURES; SPEECH WORK: CONSONANTS FOLLOWED BY /j/ AND /u/

Structure: Review of Nominalization of Adjectives and Verbs

Nominalization is the process by which words other than nouns are made to function and behave as nouns. They become nouns through Suffixation and Conversion.

- **Suffixation (Verbs):** Verbs take suffixes like -or/-er, -tion/-ation, -age, -ant, -ment, -ice, -ee, -al, -ance.
  - endow – endowment
  - acquit – acquittal
  - defend – defendant
  - teach – teacher
- **Suffixation (Adjectives):** Adjectives take suffixes such as -ness, -y, -cy, -ty, -ism, -hood, -ity, -ist, -th.
  - good – goodness
  - false – falsehood
  - ideal – idealist/idealism
  - deep – depth
- **Conversion:** Verbs and adjectives become nouns by taking on the definite article "the" or by using the present participle (-ing).
  - *Verb:* They pay me well. -> *Noun:* The pay is good.
  - *Verb:* He was injured. -> *Noun:* The injured were taken to the hospital.
  - *Participle:* Weeping does not solve the problem.
  - *Adjective:* Tunde is an honest man. -> *Noun:* The honest receive their reward in the end.

Summary: Revision of the Features of Summary

A summary is a brief account of what has been read or heard, requiring short but concise information without giving all the details.

- **Features:** Brevity, Clarity, Relevance, and Coverage.
- **Useful Hints:**
  - Read the passage at least twice to ensure thorough understanding.
  - Identify the thesis statement and topic sentences.
  - Adhere strictly to instructions (e.g., "state in sentences"). Do not write in phrases.
  - Do not lump two points in one sentence.
  - Write the answers in your own words. Avoid mindless lifting.
  - Avoid illustrations, repetitions, and extraneous materials.

Speech Work: Consonants Followed by /j/ and /u/ sounds

A consonant cluster is the occurrence of two or more consonants without an intervening vowel. Some words show the presence of hidden sounds like /j/ (the 'y' sound) only when pronounced.

- New -> /nju:/
- Few -> /fju:/
- Cute -> /kju:t/
- Tune -> /tju:n/
- View -> /vju:/
- Stupid -> /stju:pid/
- Student -> /stju:dənt/
- Human -> /hju:mən/

WEEK 2

TOPICS: VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT: HUMAN BODY SYSTEM; SPEECH WORK: CONSONANT CLUSTERS; WRITING: EXPOSITORY ESSAY

Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Human Body Parts

- **Skin:** An elastic organ that covers the entire body.
- **Ears:** Funnel-like organs on both sides of the head used for perceiving sounds.
- **Eyes:** Spherical organs found in front of the head within the eye sockets.
- **Nose:** The protruded part of the face which has two nostrils which channel air to the nasal cavity.
- **Mouth:** The channel to the digestive system. Constitutes lips, jaw, teeth, and tongue to aid chewing.
- **Lungs:** A pair of pale pink broad organs in the chest region, mainly for respiration.
- **Kidney:** A pair of reddish bean-shaped organs in the abdomen that produce urine and excrete waste.
- **Spleen:** Serves as a reservoir for blood in the body.
- **Heart:** A muscular structure in the thoracic region that pumps blood through the arteries.
- **Brain:** The center of reasoning and intelligence that controls the nervous system.
- **Oesophagus:** A long tube that connects the mouth to the stomach.

Speech Work: Cluster of Two, Three, and Four Consonants

- **Two Consonant Clusters:**
  - *Initial:* Smile, Gland, Dwell, Play, Plate
  - *Medial:* Plantain, Plastic, Okro, Offset, Condemn
  - *Final:* Cast, Band, King, Dogs, Books
- **Three Consonant Clusters:**
  - *Initial:* Scrawl, Splint, Scrap, Square
  - *Medial:* Restrain, Constrain, Construction, Transform
  - *Final:* Ants, Lumps, Nests, Opts, Masks

- **Four Consonant Clusters:**
  - *Final:* Sixths, Prompts, Glimpsed, Exempts

Writing: Expository Essay

- An expository essay requires you to explain a thing or a process. It combines narration, descriptions, with explanation, illustration, and argumentation.
- **Features:** Must have a heading, an introductory paragraph, a body containing at least three well-developed paragraphs, and a concluding paragraph. The present tense is usually used.

WEEK 3

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: NOUN PHRASES; VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT: HEALTH

Structure: Noun Phrases

A noun phrase is a phrase that has a noun as its headword and performs any of the functions of a noun.

- **Types of Noun Phrases:**
  - *Standard:* The fat woman with a tiny voice.
  - *Gerundial Phrase:* Introduced by a verb ending in -ing (e.g., "Fixing that computer should not be a problem").
  - *Infinitive Phrase:* Identified by an infinitive (e.g., "To fix that computer should not be a problem").
- **Functions of Noun Phrases:**
  - *Subject of the verb:* The young woman in pink gown is watching us.
  - *Object of the verb:* The girl bought a big brown bag.
  - *Subject complement:* Our principal is a hard-working woman.
  - *Object complement:* The infamous leader calls himself an evil genius.
  - *Complement of preposition:* The man died after a prolonged illness.
  - *Noun in apposition:* Roberts's fiancée hails from Ondo, a town in the west of Nigeria.

Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Health

- **Contract:** To get a disease or to be infected.
- **Syndrome:** A pattern of illnesses that go together.
- **Chronic:** Long-lasting disease or illness.
- **Convalescence:** A resting period after recovery from an illness.
- **Transfusion:** Giving a person blood that has been supplied by someone else.
- **Viruses:** Tiny organisms, smaller than bacteria, which cause disease.
- **Contagious:** Spread by having contact with a patient suffering from it.
- **Coma:** State of unconsciousness.

- **Anesthesia:** Given when an operation is about to be carried out to prevent pain.
- **Intravenous:** Given through the vein.
- **Debilitating:** Weakening.
- **Relapse:** Fall back into the illness after recovery.

WEEK 4

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: RELATIVE PRONOUNS; VOCABULARY: BUILDING AND CONSTRUCTION; WRITING: NARRATIVE ESSAY

Structure: Relative Pronouns

A relative pronoun is a word that relates or links an adjectival or relative clause to the word it describes (its antecedent).

- **Pronouns include:** who, whom, that, which, whose, where, when.
- **Usage Rules:** "Who" (subject), "whom" (object), and "whose" (possessive) are used strictly in reference to people. "Which" is used for things, while "that" goes with people or things.
- **Examples:**
  - That is the boy *whose* father once killed an elephant.
  - I can identify the boy *who* took your toy.
  - He wrote the poem *which* won the prize.
  - The time *when* I was asleep was when he came in.

Vocabulary Development: Building

- **Trench:** A long narrow ditch or hole dug in the ground.
- **Concrete:** Mixture of cement, sand, gravel, and water that hardens as it dries.
- **Foundation:** Part of a house on which the other parts rest for support.
- **D.P.C (Damp Proof Course):** Layer of material applied to prevent moisture or damp from passing through a wall or floor.
- **Scaffold:** A structure made of scaffolding, for workers to stand on while working on a building.
- **Glazier:** A person whose job is to put glass in windows.
- **German floor:** Concrete floor made over the short walls of a foundation to the ground floor.
- **Plumbers:** An individual who fits water pipes, basins, baths, water tanks, etc.
- **Gravel:** Pebbles and pieces of rock coarser than sand.

Writing: Narrative Essay

- A narrative essay involves giving an account of an incident or event in which somebody was involved.
- **Core Elements:** Every narrative involves people, action, time, and place.
- **Features:** Use past tense forms. Ensure natural sequence of events (chronological order). Ensure linkage of events for unity and coherence. Paragraph properly into introduction, body, and conclusion.

WEEK 5

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: UNSTRESSED VOWEL /ə/; WRITING: ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY

Speech Work: Unstressed Vowel /ə/ (Schwa)

The "schwa" is a short vowel produced with the lips in a neutral position. It is represented by many letters, usually in unaccented (unstressed) syllables. It can occur in initial, medial, or final positions.

- **Initial:** allow, adore, approve, obstruct, achieve, agree, offence, above.
- **Medial:** perhaps, understand, entertain, ignorant, permanent, comfortable, contain.
- **Final:** sailor, factor, baker, doctor, water, teacher, famous, mother.

Writing: Argumentative Essay

- An argumentative essay requires you to present a subject with a view to persuading your reader to agree with your point of view against another.
- **Features:**
  - Heading: Preferably written in capitals.
  - Introduction: A paragraph containing a clear statement of purpose or definition of the subject.
  - Body: At least three well-developed paragraphs, each with a topic sentence and supporting arguments.
  - Conclusion: A final paragraph containing recommendations or a strong closing statement.

WEEK 6

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: SENTENCE TYPES; SPEECH WORK: STRESS OF FOUR SYLLABLE WORDS; WRITING: DESCRIPTIVE ESSAY

Structure: Sentence Types According to Structure

- **Simple Sentence:** Contains only one independent clause (e.g., "The notorious robber has been executed").
- **Compound Sentence:** Made up of two main clauses linked by a co-ordinating conjunction like and, but, or (e.g., "Emmanuel attended all the lectures but he did not sit for the examination").
- **Complex Sentence:** Made up of one main clause and one or more subordinate clauses connected by a subordinating conjunction (e.g., "We brought the book which he recommended").
- **Compound-Complex Sentence:** Made up of at least two main clauses and one or more subordinate clauses (e.g., "I had left the house and boarded a taxi when I looked back to see my younger sister waving me down").
- **Multiple Sentence:** Made up of more than two main clauses joined by co-ordinating conjunctions (e.g., "I will go to the office and ask the Manager to sign the form but I will not submit it today").

Speech Work: Stress of Four Syllable Words

Words of three or more syllables have different stress patterns depending on their suffixes.

- demarCAtion
- FORtunately
- POsitively
- NEpotism
- TRIbalism
- poLItical
- cerTIficate
- comMUnicate
- imPOSsible

- reCIProcate
- ecoNOmic
- photoGRAphic
- indiGEStion
- superVIsion
- inVEStigate
- adMINister

Writing: Descriptive Essay

- Requires the writer to describe a thing, place, or person, placing emphasis on definite qualities or characteristics rather than action.
- **Tips:** Form a good mental picture. Translate the picture into true-to-life words. Get fully involved in the description. Avoid flat enumeration of facts; instead, show how things look, feel, or happen.

WEEK 7

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: ADVERBS AND TYPES

Structure: Adverbs and Types

An adverb is a word that modifies or offers additional information about a verb, an adjective, another adverb, a phrase, or an entire sentence.

- **Adverbs modifying verbs:** She dances *well*.
- **Adverbs modifying adverbs:** He scored the goal *quite* easily.
- **Adverbs modifying adjectives:** That well is *incredibly* deep.
- **Adverbs modifying phrases:** They were caught *right* in the act.

Types of Adverbs:

- **Adverbs of Time/Place (When/Where?):** there, here, outside, out, tomorrow, yesterday.
- **Adverbs of Frequency (How often?):** seldom, hardly, rarely, never, sometimes, occasionally.
- **Adverbs of Degree (To what extent?):** badly, extremely, greatly, too, much, quite, so.
- **Adverbs of Manner (How?):** well, quickly, happily.

WEEK 8

TOPICS: VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT: SMELL, TASTE AND COLOUR; STRUCTURE: WORD MODIFIERS; WRITING: REPORT WRITING

Vocabulary Development: Smell, Taste and Colour

- **Adjectives of Smell:**
  - *Pleasant:* fragrant, perfumed, scented, sweet, fresh, floral, fruity.
  - *Unpleasant:* acrid, fetid, putrid, stinking, rancid, rotten, pungent, tart.
- **Adjectives of Taste:** bitter, hot, piquant, salty, sharp, sour, spicy, stale, crispy, garlicky, lemony.
- **Adjectives of Colour:** amber, lilac, black, navy, blue, bronze, olive, red, orange, orchid, pale, peach, charcoal, chocolate, pink, purple, coral, silver, fuchsia, topaz, green, henna, indigo, vermilion, lemon, turquoise.

Structure: Word Modifiers (Adjectives and Adverbs)

A modifier is a word or phrase added to another word to give a clearer picture. Using varied and apt modifiers makes descriptive/narrative essays more interesting.

- **Adjectives (Modify Nouns):**
  - *Sight:* slender, amorphous, ugly, colossal, scruffy, trim.
  - *Feeling:* airy, soothing, unerring, cooling, refreshing, gentle.
  - *Touch:* feathery, wooly, tepid, hot, thorny, prickly, ice-cold.
  - *Character:* crooked, fickle, flighty, frivolous, quick-witted.
- **Adverbs (Modify Verbs):**
  - *Movement:* jerkily, rapidly, awkwardly, sluggishly, gingerly, cautiously.
  - *Frequency:* occasionally, permanently, rarely, bi-monthly.
  - *Manner:* brazenly, brusquely, fiercely, nonchalantly, rashly, thoughtlessly.

Writing: A Report

- A report is an account of a happening (e.g., a meeting, event, or incident). It is similar to a narrative but often includes the writer's comments or criticisms.

- **Features:** Requires a straightforward account in simple, uncomplicated language. Presented in proper sequence (usually chronological). Grouped into clear paragraphs. Must use correct past tense forms. Follows formal layout (Date, Salutation, Title, Sign-off with Name and Post).

WEEK 9

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: PLURAL FORMS OF NOUNS; SPEECH WORK: STRESS OF FIVE SYLLABLE WORDS; WRITING: SHORT STORY

Structure: Plural Forms of Nouns

- **Addition of -s:** tables, stones, keys, books, sisters.
- **Addition of -es:** For words ending in -s, -x, -sh, -ch, -o (e.g., potatoes, bonuses, boxes, churches, dishes).
  - *Exceptions for -o:* pianos, zoos, kangaroos.
- **Addition of -en/-ren:** children, oxen.
- **Ending in -f / -fe:** Change to '-ves' (beliefs, chiefs, calves, thieves, leaves, wives).
  - *Double plurals:* dwarfs/dwarves, scarfs/scarves, hoofs/hooves.
- **Ending in 'y':**
  - Preceded by consonant: change to 'ies' (cities, babies, lorries).
  - Preceded by vowel: add 's' (trays, donkeys, toys).
- **Vowel Changes:** foot/feet, man/men, goose/geese, mouse/mice, tooth/teeth.
- **'is' to 'es':** axis/axes, crisis/crises, hypothesis/hypotheses.
- **Unchanged / Zero Plurals:** deer, cattle, sheep, swine, furniture, information, baggage, luggage, damage, knowledge, advice.
- **Plural in form but singular in usage:** news, Physics, Mathematics, measles, politics.
- **Foreign Plurals:** datum/data, criterion/criteria, medium/media, formula/formulae.

Speech Work: Stress of Five Syllable Words

- **Words ending in -ion:** Stress the second syllable from the end (e.g., adminisTRAtion, confedeRAtion, privatiZAtion, examiNAtion).
- **Words ending in -ity:** Stress the third syllable from the end (e.g., authenTIcity, conducTIvity, elecTRIcity).
- **Words ending in -al:** Stress the third syllable from the end (e.g., agriCULtural, interNAtional, converSAtional).

- **Words ending in -ism, -ive, -ible/-able:** Stress the fourth syllable from the end (e.g., imPErialism, repreSENtative, inexHAUstible).

Writing: Creative Writing - Features of a Short Story

- A short story is a narration created from imagination or factual events.
- **Theme:** The central point from which the story is developed.
- **Plot:** The storyline or order of events used to develop the theme.
- **Characters:** The people involved in the actions. Best developed through names and dialogue.
- **Setting:** Where and when the events take place.
- **Structure:** Must have a beginning, climax, anti-climax, and conclusion. A writer can start from the beginning, the climax, or the conclusion.
- **Language:** Tense is generally past, except in active dialogue. Use imagery that appeals to the senses.

WEEK 10

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: PHRASAL VERBS; WRITING: INFORMAL LETTER

Structure: Phrasal Verbs

Verbs combine with adverbial particles to form multi-word verbs. The meaning cannot be determined by looking at the verb and particle in isolation; it must be comprehended from the entire phrase.

- Turn down: refuse, reject.
- Give in: surrender.
- Run across: meet by chance.
- Fall on: attack.
- Fall out: quarrel.
- Give up: stop.

Phrasal verbs with double particles:

- Done away with: abolished.
- Put up with: tolerate.
- Goes back on: breaks (a promise).
- Look in on: visit.
- Fed up with: tired of.

Writing: Features and Format of an Informal Letter

- Informal letters are friendly letters to contemporaries (friends, colleagues), close older relatives, or pen-pals.
- **Features:** Chatty, open-minded language. Familiar tone with acceptable use of colloquialisms and contracted forms (I'm, you've, can't). First paragraph usually inquires about welfare. Concluding paragraph sends greetings to mutual acquaintances.
- **Format:**
  - Writer's Address (Top right)
  - Date (Under address)
  - Salutation (e.g., "My dear Bisi,")

- Body (Introductory paragraph, Main content paragraphs, Conclusion)
- Subscription/Sign-off (e.g., "Yours sincerely," followed by First name only).